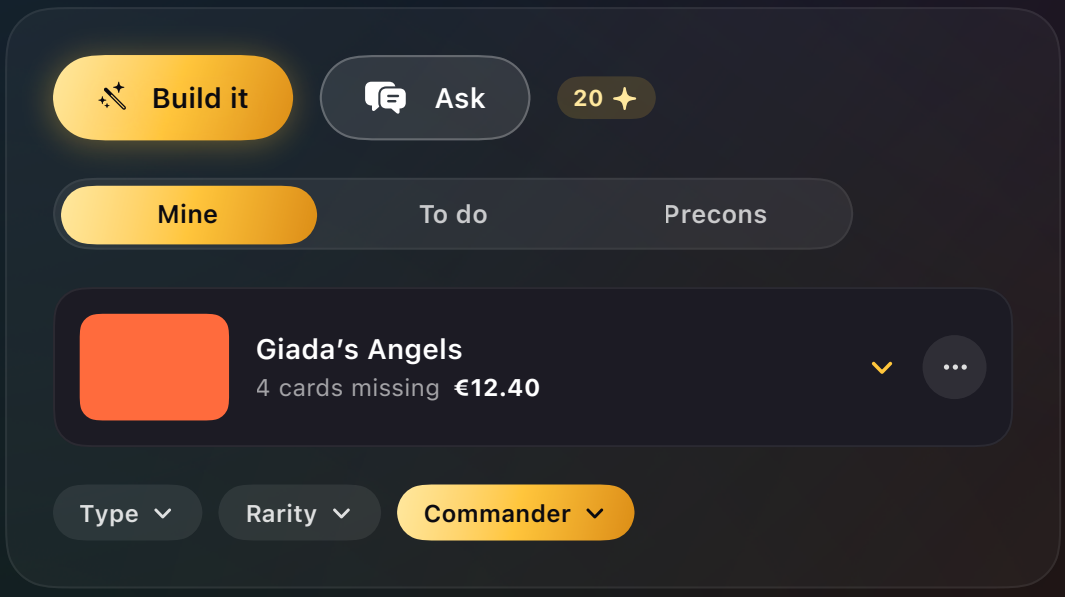
ManaPal

Design system

The app's principles, colors, themes, typography, spacing, components and patterns. Every new screen starts here.



October 2026 · iOS 18 and iOS 26

Albo's Apps

PRINCIPLES

Six principles

The design system exists for one reason: every screen should look like it was made by the same hand. When a choice isn't covered by this document, start from these principles.

1. **Cards are the stars**
   The interface is dark and calm because Magic's artwork already has every color. No giant backgrounds behind text: images live in thumbnails or dedicated heroes.
2. **Gold guides, it doesn't decorate**
   The accent color (gold in the base theme) marks the main action, selection and important values. Only one gold button per screen.
3. **One rhythm**
   Spacing, radii and heights come from tokens. Two different screens must have the same distance between section title and content.
4. **Hierarchy first**
   Every block has a title, content and at most one action. Secondary actions go in a "..." menu, not at the bottom of the list.
5. **Instant response to touch**
   Feedback comes immediately (press, haptic, transition); heavy content loads afterwards, with a loader if needed.
6. **For everyone**
   Dynamic Type, VoiceOver, Reduce Motion and sufficient contrast are part of the component, not added at the end.

Two operating systems
The app runs on iOS 18 and iOS 26. Liquid Glass is used on iOS 26 with an equivalent look on iOS 18: same space, same hierarchy, different material.

FOUNDATIONS

Colors

Few colors, each with a precise role. Code always uses AppTheme tokens, never hand-written values: that way Pro themes work everywhere.

Brand (ManaPal theme)

gold
`AppTheme.gold`

goldDeep
`AppTheme.goldDeep`

goldLight
`AppTheme.goldLight`

arcane
`AppTheme.arcane`

ink
`text on gold, background`

inkRaised
`raised surfaces`

surface
`.background.secondary`

stroke
`white 6–8%`

Mana colors

White
`ManaColor.white`

Blue
`ManaColor.blue`

Black
`ManaColor.black`

Red
`ManaColor.red`

Green
`ManaColor.green`

Used for color identity, fallback gradients when artwork is missing (`AppTheme.colorGradient(for:)`), tab accents in the tab bar and background glows.

Semantic

Success
`Owned, on target`

Warning
`Below recommended`

Destructive
`Delete, remove`

Info
`Above recommended`

Text and transparency

- Text: `.primary` for content, `.secondary` for details and captions, `.tertiary` only for decorative elements (never for text meant to be read).
- Surfaces on a dark background: white at **4%** (panels), **7%** (pickers, chips), **9%** (icon buttons); borders at **6–8%**, 0.75 pt thick.
- On artwork, text always sits on a surface, never directly on the image.

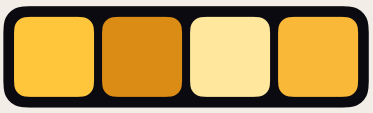
FOUNDATIONS

Themes

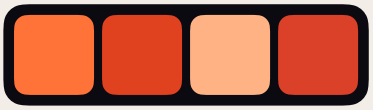
The ManaPal theme is free; Pro unlocks six more. A theme changes accent, background and buttons, never the structure.



ManaPal
Free · all the mana colors



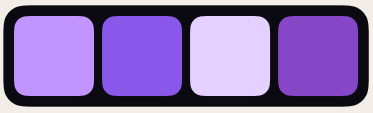
Golden Dawn
Pro · white, aura and glossy buttons



Ember
Pro · red, embers



Abyss
Pro · blue, currents



Necropolis
Pro · black, fog



Forest
Pro · green, fireflies



Graphite
Pro · gray, flat buttons

Accent · deep accent · light accent · background dominant

Rules

- The **logo** and icon always stay those of the ManaPal theme; Mote takes the theme accent, just slightly lighter.
- Each theme defines `AppThemePalette` (accent, dominant, secondary, lower intensity) and `AppThemeEffects` (button glow, sheen and border, flat buttons, ambient shader).
- Ambient shaders run at half resolution and 30 fps, and stop off screen, in the background, during games and with Reduce Motion.
- Backgrounds are always dark and subtle, darker at the bottom where the tab bar and buttons sit.

FOUNDATIONS

Typography

Two families: **Young Serif** for headings, which give the fantasy character, and **SF Pro** for everything else. Every size follows Dynamic Type.

Large title	`.brandTitle(.largeTitle) · 34` Tab title, hero
Section title	`.brandTitle(.title3) · 20` SectionEyebrow, block titles
Headline	`.headline · 17 semibold` Card and deck names in rows
Body / Callout	`.body · 17 / .callout · 16` Long text, Mote's answers
Subheadline	`.subheadline · 15` Small buttons, pickers, values
Footnote	`.footnote · 13` Reasons, notes
Caption	`.caption · 12` Captions, counts, metadata

Rules

- Never fixed sizes: `Font.brandTitle(_:)` uses `relativeTo:` and scales with Dynamic Type; everything else uses system styles.
- Bold is done with `.bold()`; `.fontWeight()` only for the semibold of buttons and row titles.
- Numbers, prices and counters use `.monospacedDigit()` so they don't jump when they change.
- Young Serif doesn't go in long text, list rows, buttons or numbers.
- At accessibility sizes rows wrap instead of truncating; pickers become menus.

FOUNDATIONS

Spacing and radii

Four spacing tokens in `AppTheme+Spacing.swift` set the vertical rhythm of the whole app.

`sectionSpacing`	28		Between two sections of the same screen
`cardInfoSpacing`	22		Between a hero (card, summary) and the content
`groupSpacing`	12		Between items of the same group, panel padding
`sectionHeaderSpacing`	10		Between section title and content
`screen margin`	16		system .padding() on the sides

Radii



10 · Thumbnails **14 · Inner panels** **16 · Rows and cards** **22 · Heroes and large cards**

Capsule
Buttons, chips, pickers

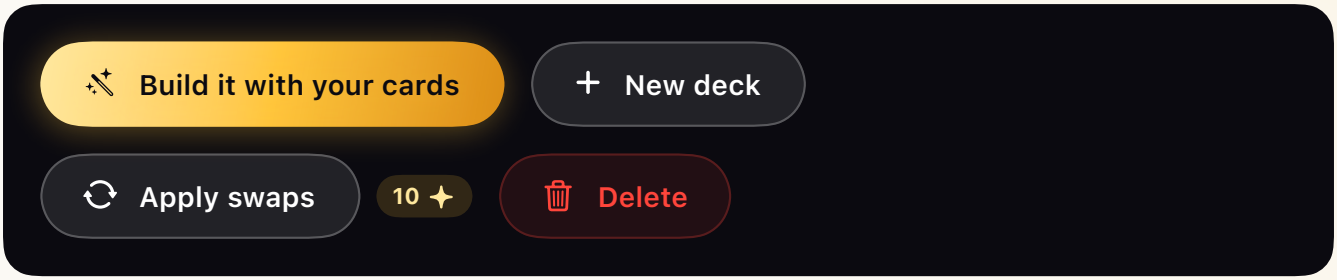
The code still also has 8, 12, 18 and 20: they should gradually move to this scale. Large shapes always use `.continuous`.

Minimum sizes

- Minimum tap area **44 × 44 pt**; icon buttons drawn at 28–30 pt with a larger hit area.
- Segmented pickers: **36 pt** total height everywhere (30 + 3 inner border).
- Card thumbnails in rows: 40 pt wide; deck artwork: 76–100 pt, 0.72 ratio.
- Use `@ScaledMetric` for measurements that should grow with text.

COMPONENTS

Buttons



`.gold` · main action, one per screen. `.secondary` · all the others. AI actions always show their cost with `ManaCostTag`.



Icon buttons: 9% circle, bold glyph. Sheets always close with `CloseButton`. The floating button (`FloatingActionButton`) sits bottom right, gold, with a VoiceOver label.

Rules

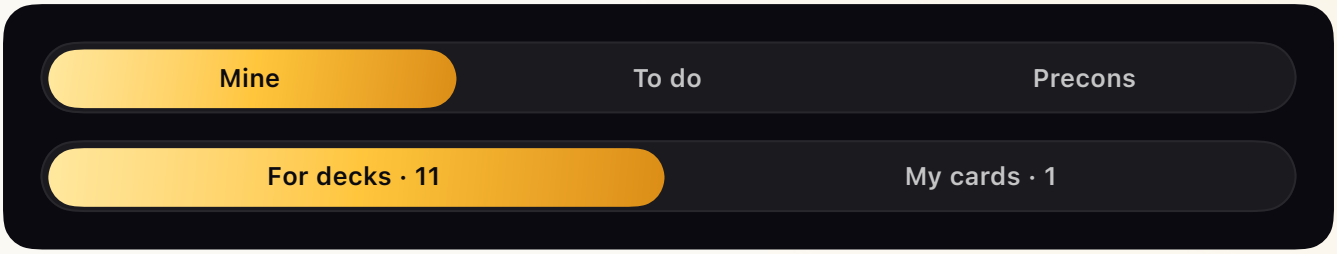
- A button with an image always has text too: `Button("Add", systemImage: "plus")`.
- Never `onTapGesture` for an action: always `Button`, with `PressableStyle` for tappable cards and rows.
- `.controlSize(.large)` only for the main action of a whole screen, never inside a list.
- Two side-by-side actions have the same width; with long text they wrap to two lines, never shrinking below 75%.
- Destructive actions ask for confirmation with `confirmationDialog`.

✓ An item's secondary actions go in the ... menu at the top right of the row.

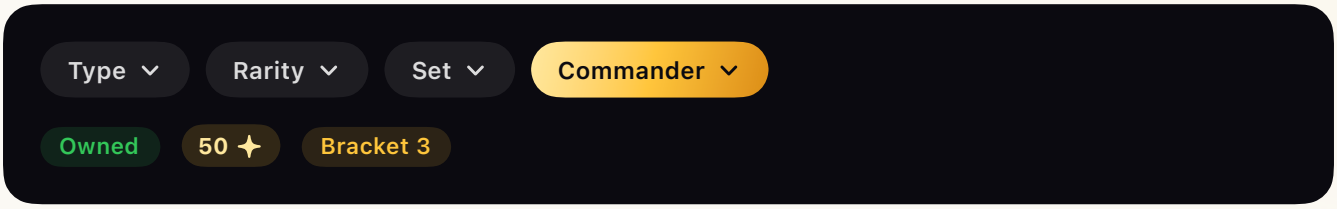
✗ "Open" and "Buy" rows at the bottom of an expanded list, far from the item.

COMPONENTS

Pickers, chips and badges



`GoldSegmentedPicker` · the app's only segmented picker, same height everywhere (36 pt). Two or three items; with very large Dynamic Type it becomes a menu.



Filter chips (`FilterChip`, `MenuChipLabel`): 8% capsule, gold when the filter is on. Info badges (`InfoPill`, `OwnershipBadge`, `ManaCostTag`) smaller and not tappable.



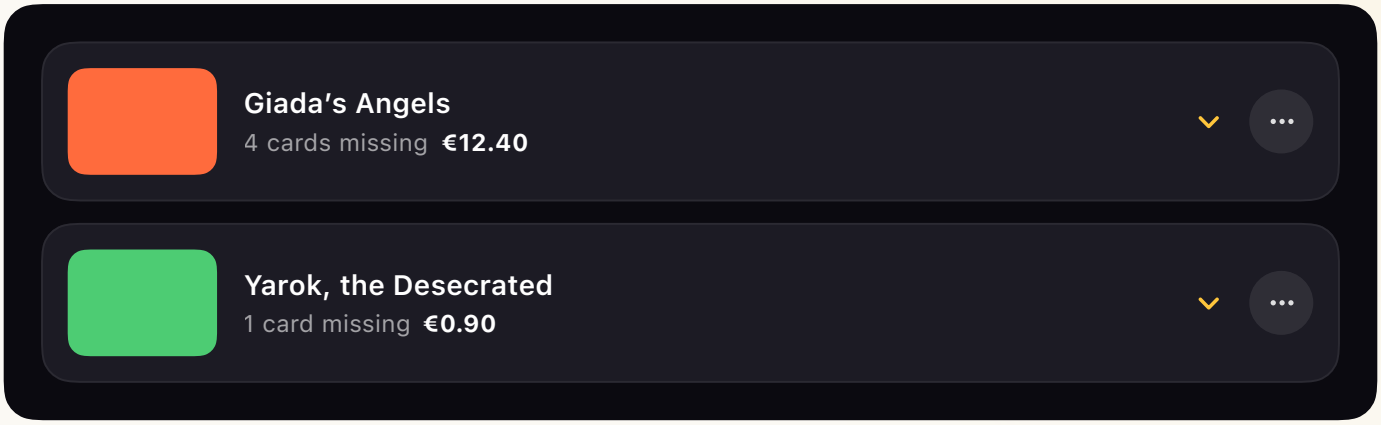
Collapsible header (`DeckEntriesHeaderButton`): title, count, group icon and chevron. Same shape for deck groups, card types and "Already bought".

Rules

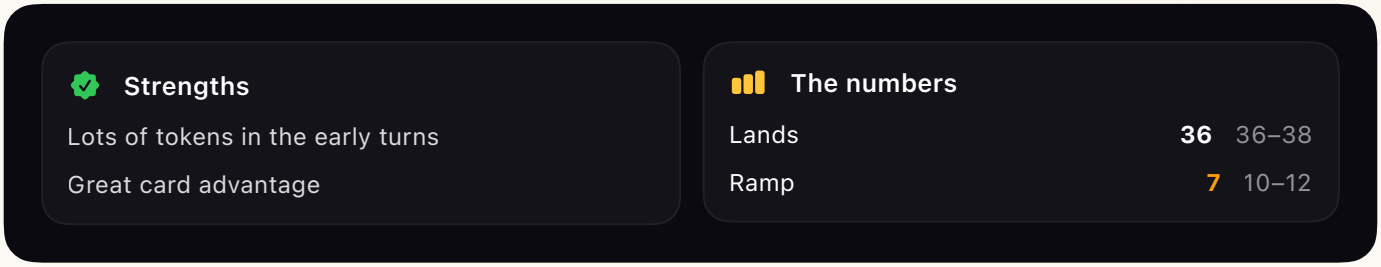
- No system `Picker` in `.segmented` style and no toggles to show or hide content: use a collapsible section.
- The count next to the title is secondary and monospaced.
- The chevron rotates: right when closed, down when open. A right arrow that doesn't rotate means navigation.

COMPONENTS

Surfaces and rows



Row for an item with an image: thumbnail on the left, name in headline, secondary details with the value in bold, an open chevron and a "..." menu. The name wraps to two lines before truncating.



Panel (`DeckReportPanel`): white at 4%, 6% border, radius 14, title with a colored icon. Used to split long content into readable blocks.

Layers

Layer	Component	Use
Background	appCanvas()	Animated theme mesh, always behind everything
Card	cardBackground()	Summaries, reports, single rows
Grouped list	SurfaceSection	Lists of rows with rounded corners only at the ends
Band	FullBleedBand	Full-width content inside a List (deck cards)
Panel	DeckReportPanel	Blocks inside a card

PATTERNS

Patterns

Screen structure

- Large title in Young Serif (`appNavigationTitle(_:large:)`), then the hero or summary, then sections with `SectionEyebrow`.
- Long lists hide the top bar and tab bar when scrolling down (`hidesBarsOnScroll()`); content reaches the edge of the screen.
- Horizontal scrolls run edge to edge (`edgeToEdgeScroll()`), with snapping cards (`.viewAligned`).
- Floating button for the create action, always bottom right, with 90 pt of space at the end of lists.

Lists with details

- Tap the row → opens or expands. Actions on the item → "…" menu. Actions on the whole list → in the summary at the top.
- Completed items (cards acquired, finished decks) go in a collapsible section at the bottom, closed by default, with an action to remove them.

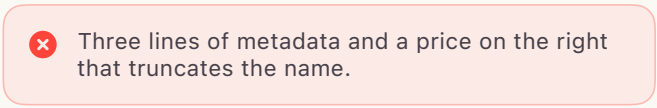
States

- Empty: `ContentUnavailableView` with Mote, one explaining sentence and at most one action.
- Loading: the screen responds immediately, then `screenLoading` or a skeleton; never a frozen screen.
- Error: what happened, what to do, "Try again". Undelivered Mana comes back, and we say so.
- Light confirmations with a toast at the bottom; no alerts for things that went well.

Copy

- Plain language, short sentences, second person. No technical jargon and no promises the app doesn't keep.
- Catalog keys in Italian, translated into the 14 languages before every tester build.





MOTION

Motion, haptics and Mote

Use	Animation
State changes, expand and collapse	.snappy
Button presses	.spring(response: 0.25, dampingFraction: 0.65), scale 0.96–0.97
Pickers and chevrons	.spring(response: 0.35, dampingFraction: 0.75–0.8)
Hiding bars	.snappy(duration: 0.28)
Continuous effects (Mote, logo, rays)	LiveTimeline at 30 fps, paused off screen

Haptics

- `.selection` when a selection changes; `.impact(weight: .light)` when crossing a threshold (zoom, dragging a card to dismiss); `.impact(weight: .medium)` for the card flip.

Reduce Motion

- Shaders and continuous animations stop; transitions become crossfades.
- No information is conveyed by motion alone.

Mote

- A living drop of Mana with 12 expressions: it welcomes, explains, celebrates. It falls asleep after 25 seconds and wakes up when tapped; held down, it inflates like a balloon until it pops.
- It appears in empty states, onboarding, AI waits and celebrations; never during a sale or after a user error.
- In speech bubbles it speaks in the first person, in short sentences.



CHECKLIST

Checklist for a new screen

1. **Tokens**
   Colors from AppTheme, spacing from the four tokens, radii from the 10 · 14 · 16 · 22 · capsule scale.
2. **Hierarchy**
   One title per block, one gold main action, secondary ones in the "…" menu.
3. **Existing components**
   GoldSegmentedPicker, SectionEyebrow, SurfaceSection, DeckEntriesHeaderButton, CollapseChevron, FloatingActionButton, CloseButton before creating new ones.
4. **Text**
   Dynamic Type up to AX5, no truncation of main names, monospaced numbers.
5. **Accessibility**
   VoiceOver labels and traits, headers marked with .isHeader, at least 4.5:1 contrast for text.
6. **Themes**
   Test the screen with ManaPal, Golden Dawn and Graphite (flat buttons).
7. **Devices**
   iPhone 13 mini on iOS 18 and a recent iPhone on iOS 26; iPad and Mac for the main screens.
8. **Performance**
   Immediate touch feedback, heavy work off the main thread, animations paused when not visible.
9. **Languages**
   Strings in the catalog and translated into the 14 languages.

Where the design system lives in code
`Shared/Design`: AppTheme and AppTheme+Spacing (tokens), Theme (Pro themes), Font+Brand (Young Serif), GoldButtonStyle and SecondaryButtonStyle, GoldSegmentedPicker, ListSurface, SectionEyebrow, Effects (LiveTimeline, shaders) and Mascot (Mote).

ManaPal · Design system

Update it whenever a new component is born.